

Moonsea Rising - 20230924

Aftermath

As Taevyn catches his breath, Harken curses under his. "Damn it. Almost had her." The party reconvenes on the floor of the warehouse. Lirael asks if they think they might catch her, as they'll never have a better opportunity to finish her off. Everyone else -- her back is turned -- catches that a work desk, more of a door with legs than a true desk, is sitting in the corner, groaning under a substantial weight of paperwork.

Striding over, Harken starts rifling through the papers, pulling out a number of ledger entries, as well as some personal correspondence between Tomag, Fyndellion, and Autumn Silverweave about this operation -- though in several of the documents they used the pseudonym "Silverware". Clearly in league with the Militarists and Maxilar Brule, the TrueSilk™ and ColdSilver® are clearly intended for a military purpose.

The TrueSilk™ doesn't appear to be magical at all. Lirael is impressed, though her distaste with House Silverweave's methods is evident. Harken and Beitris are hell-bent on burning down the warehouse, which seems like it will disrupt this scheme, since the ledgers don't show any shipments leaving.

The timeline suggests all of this was started by an order nearly a year ago, well before Edric III's death. The party begins wondering if there are other locations in effect, but the numbers for this location alone are staggering. As they consider destroying millions of gold worth of TrueSilk™, Lennox wonders if there are rivals of House Silverweave that might have use of the product. Beitris knows that House Brightsail, maker of sails for House Elgata's navy, would love to get into the business of fashion.

As they pack up to go, Lirael circles the building locating two more magical trees, both of which contain magical runes, one to the west, one to the southeast, and the original large tree to the north. She posits that the northern one is likely for carts for the outgoing shipments, while the other two might go to Jambis and New Towne.

Beitris remembers a scrap of paper she found in the warehouse. It had three sets of initials, as well as a word. Those are: NT - bingo, MV - fruit tree, PB - logarithm. They guess that those might be New Towne, Melvaunt, and the Palace of Birdsong. Lirael remarks that burning this lot is both going to ruin at least one noble house, as well as possibly marring the remaining teleporters.

They resolve to try the southeastern teleporter, on the premise that it's likely to be New Towne, and using the password "bingo" has them standing in the hag's supposed house in New Towne. They quickly search the house, finding no recent evidence of Bronwyn's return. They quickly debate whether to try and return to the warehouse before the fire consumes the other circles.

They try a couple of the command words, but nothing happens. Lirael posits that the rug might interfere with the sending. Rolling up the carpet, they manage to teleport back to the tree. While the invisible warehouse is merrily blazing, they hurry around to the other smaller tree. Speaking

the word "logarithm" they are transported to a luxurious vaulted room, with an intricate inlaid rune of stained glass. A dome of stars overhead, an alchemy set in the corner, and a pulsating glowing Bronwyn slumped in a chair. At the door stands Count Bartleby. He says, "ah, you're here. Sooner than expected. 'Malvolio'." Everyone's stomach lurches.